

Alexander Gagnon

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Engineering manager with 8+ years of experience leading SDET teams, building developer tools, and driving AI adoption across engineering organizations. Track record of growing teams, establishing quality standards, modernizing processes, and delivering measurable efficiency gains through automation and AI-powered tooling. Combines technical depth in Python, CI/CD, and LLM integrations with a focus on team development, cross-functional collaboration, and organizational impact.

EXPERIENCE

Manager, QA Automation | Vestmark

Feb 2024 – Present

Team Lead, QA Automation

Feb 2023 – Feb 2024

Senior QA Automation Engineer

Jun 2021 – Feb 2023

- Manage and mentor a team of 11 SDETs across multiple products, owning automation strategy, hiring, performance management, and career development. Promoted from Senior Engineer to Team Lead to Manager within two years.
- Grew the team by creating the first internship program (intern delivered 30 net new tests across two semesters) and hiring the first full-time SDET in three years, with the new hire contributing to production suites within 2-3 weeks.
- Led a company-wide initiative to align team titles and job descriptions with actual roles and responsibilities, securing buy-in from QA leadership, engineering managers, and HR.
- Championed AI adoption across the QA organization: directed the team to build an AI-powered nightly monitoring tool saving ~100 hours per month, and created the QE Marketplace, an enterprise repository of AI-powered plugins with training sessions and demos across engineering.
- Led the team to deliver 700+ automated API tests from the ground up in four months, uncovering ~30 previously undetected issues including 5 critical bugs. Directed a complete UI automation suite overhaul catching ~120 defects.
- Leading an initiative to redesign test processes through an AI-augmented workflow with human-in-the-loop review. Modernized organizational processes and documentation adopted across engineering.

Test Automation Software Engineer | Escher Group

Mar 2020 – May 2021

- Standardized Python automation frameworks for desktop and mobile products, reducing production bugs by 10%. Built CI/CD pipelines on Bamboo and Azure Cloud saving 1,000+ developer hours annually. Engineered a full-stack monitoring app with Azure OAuth, cutting developer labor by 500+ hours annually.

Software QA Engineer | Firebrand Technologies

Jul 2019 – Mar 2020

- Joined as a manual tester, identified the absence of automation and performance testing, and self-taught C# and JMeter to independently design, build, and own both frameworks from scratch. Reduced manual effort by 1,200+ hours annually and leveraged performance data to drive infrastructure improvements with leadership. Began training team members to contribute.

Software QA Specialist | Transparent Language

Mar 2018 – Jun 2019

- Promoted from manual tester to database testing. Built Python validation tests for blue/green MongoDB deployments, catching significant data loss during switchovers. Monitored RabbitMQ throughput and identified critical bugs. Earned MongoDB certifications.

PROJECTS & AI TOOLING

QE Marketplace — Python, Claude Plugins, MCP Servers, Shell & Bash

- Enterprise repository of plugins spanning bug reporting, test failure triage, tech-pub documentation generation, and performance goal writing, plus MCP servers for Atlassian integrations and agents for task execution.

Pilot Regs — Python, RAG, Vector Search

- RAG application giving pilots faster, contextual access to FAA regulations via document ingestion, vector search, and conversational AI.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership: Team management (11 SDETs), hiring & onboarding, mentoring, career development, cross-functional collaboration, process improvement, Scrum/Agile

Languages & Automation: Python (pytest, unittest), JavaScript/TypeScript, C#, SQL, Bash, Selenium, JMeter, Locust, Groovy

AI & Developer Tooling: Anthropic API, Model Context Protocol (MCP), RAG pipelines, agentic patterns, Claude Desktop, Cursor AI

Infrastructure: Jenkins, Docker, Azure, Bamboo, Gradle, Git, Grafana, InfluxDB, SonarQube, MongoDB, RabbitMQ

EDUCATION & MILITARY SERVICE

Bachelor's Degree | University of Massachusetts, Boston

2014 – 2017

Team Leader / Corporal, M1A2 Armor Crewman | United States Army

2010 – 2013